# IT Service Continuity Briefing Q2

## Introduction

This briefing consolidates upcoming technology activities that may influence day-to-day operations across HelioFreight's warehouse and freight teams. The intent is to help regional leaders, site managers, and corporate functions plan staffing, cutover readiness, and communications to minimize workflow disruption. It also outlines how to engage IT Service Desk and escalation paths during maintenance periods. This document is prepared for internal operational planning and distribution through standard leadership channels.

## Operational Readiness and Communications

In Q1 2026, HelioFreight's Operations Readiness team refreshed the cross-functional comms playbook used for peak shipping events, including standardized outage-notification templates and distribution lists for 12 departments. The April 15, 2026 readiness survey received 684 responses and showed 78% of managers prefer SMS plus Teams for time-sensitive alerts, while 22% prefer email-only. Regional DC leaders completed two communication drills on March 7 and March 21, achieving a 94% on-time acknowledgement rate within 10 minutes. Updates were incorporated into the monthly Change Advisory Board (CAB) minutes to ensure consistent stakeholder alignment across Warehousing, Linehaul, and Customer Success.

## Planned Platform Maintenance Windows

Maintenance window governance continues to follow the CAB policy updated on February 1, 2026, requiring seven business days' notice, a rollback plan, and validation steps from Security and Network Engineering. During Q4 2025, 31 change requests were submitted for after-hours work, and 26 (84%) were approved after risk scoring and dependency checks. The standard allowable window remains 00:00–04:00 local time with a maximum of 120 minutes of change activity and 30 minutes of verification. Exceptions are reviewed quarterly with Finance and Compliance to confirm alignment with customer SLA commitments and audit controls.

## Business Continuity and Support Escalation

The 2026 Business Continuity Plan was revalidated on January 20, 2026, including updated RACI charts for IT Service Desk, Network Ops, and Warehouse Systems. A tabletop exercise on March 12, 2026 involved 48 participants and reduced average escalation handoff time from 18 minutes to 11 minutes based on revised on-call routing. Support ticket analytics for February 2026 show 1,942 incidents logged, with 92% meeting first-response SLAs and a median resolution time of 3.6 hours. Vendor escalation contacts were reconfirmed during the April 2026 contract review cycle to ensure coverage across all North American sites.

## Conclusion

Leaders should review the identified maintenance windows and align local operational plans to protect critical shipping, receiving, and customer-communication activities. Where impacts are expected, confirm pre-work completion, notify affected teams in advance, and schedule non-urgent system-dependent tasks outside of designated windows. For high-volume sites and key accounts, coordinate contingency workflows and ensure escalation contacts are current. IT will provide status updates via standard channels and capture post-activity learnings for continuous improvement.